

Dear Reviewer,

Thank you for your thoughtful review and constructive feedback on my proposal, "From Research to Reality: Connecting Western Undergraduate Students with Research that Changes Lives." I appreciate your positive assessment of the importance of this initiative, as well as its feasibility and overall design. The constructive comments you provided offer a valuable opportunity to strengthen the proposal.

I appreciate your suggestion to further emphasize the consequences of inaccessible research and the disconnect many students experience between research and their academic and professional goals. While the proposal highlights how research can appear disconnected from real-world impact, I agree that providing additional examples of the consequences of this disconnect would strengthen the rationale and further justify the need for the initiative.

Thank you for your comments regarding feasibility and implementation. I agree that contingency planning is an important consideration for an event of this scale. In a revised proposal, I would include a brief risk mitigation section outlining potential challenges related to speaker availability, venue logistics, and volunteer coordination. I understand your concern regarding the three-month planning timeline; however, this timeline was selected based on previous URSA programming and existing organizational infrastructure. Nevertheless, I agree that specifying a target event date and acknowledging the time required for speaker recruitment would improve clarity.

I also appreciate your recommendation regarding expertise and resources. The attendance statistics referenced in the proposal were drawn from previous URSA events. Including the website ([westernursa.ca](http://westernursa.ca)) and the @westernursa Instagram account would help demonstrate the credibility of these figures and provide additional context. Similarly, clarifying whether sponsorships or donations will be pursued would provide a clearer picture of the initiative's funding needs. At present, the organization does not receive external funding.

Thank you as well for your comments regarding organization and readability. The proposal introduces the initiative within the Audience and Need section after establishing the problem it seeks to address. This structure was intended to first highlight the problem before presenting the proposed solution, which was briefly introduced in the third paragraph and described in greater detail later in the proposal. However, I appreciate your suggestion and agree that providing a more explicit introduction to the initiative earlier in the proposal could further improve readability and help orient readers more quickly.

I also appreciate your suggestion regarding the inclusion of potential speakers. My intention was to provide examples of the types of researchers and community partners who may participate rather than a finalized speaker list. However, I agree that clarifying these examples as illustrative rather than exhaustive would prevent readers from assuming the event is limited to these individuals and would better communicate the flexibility of the initiative.

Thank you again for your thoughtful review and constructive recommendations. Your feedback has highlighted several opportunities to strengthen the proposal's clarity, feasibility, and overall persuasiveness. I appreciate your suggestions regarding the rationale, implementation, timeline, supporting evidence, and overall organization of the proposal. I would also incorporate a more explicit concluding statement to better reinforce the initiative's goals and anticipated impact. Thank you for the time and effort you invested in reviewing this work. -- Proposer